HOORVIA - ILLUSTRATOR PATHFINDER CHART: PRINTABLE SHAPE OPERATIONS GUIDE

Quick Reference Cheat Sheet · A4 Printable

Tech & Software · Sheet #1

Operation	Group	What It Does	Best For
Unite	Shape Mode	Merges overlapping shapes into one, keeps the front object's fill	Welding logos and icons
Minus Front	Shape Mode	Cuts the front shape out of the back shape	Punching holes, stencil cuts
Intersect	Shape Mode	Keeps only the area where all shapes overlap	Crescent moons, lens shapes
Exclude	Shape Mode	Keeps everything except the overlapping area	Rings, hollow shapes
Divide	Pathfinder	Splits shapes along every overlap into separate pieces	Breaking art into color blocks
Trim	Pathfinder	Removes hidden parts behind front shapes, strips strokes	Cleaning up layered art
Merge	Pathfinder	Joins same-fill shapes, trims hidden parts of the rest	Flattening same-color art
Crop	Pathfinder	Keeps only the back shape's area inside the front shape	Cropping art to a frame
Outline	Pathfinder	Turns every edge into stroked outlines, removes fills	Line-art conversions
Minus Back	Pathfinder	Cuts the back shape out of the front shape	Reverse stencil cuts
Expand (Alt+click)	Shape Mode	Alt+click any Shape Mode to expand it at once	Making results editable paths
Open the panel	Shortcut	Window > Pathfinder, or Shift+Ctrl+F9 (Win) / Shift+Cmd+F9 (Mac)	Fast access while drawing

PRO TIP: Mind the stacking order: Minus Front and Minus Back read top-to-bottom - check which shape is in front first.